

THE BLACK PANTHER

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ELAINE BROWN DECLARES

"OUR VICTORY OF UNITY CAN NOT BE STOLEN"



ELAINE BROWN, speaking to assembled supporters on election night at her campaign headquarters.

(Oakland, Calif.) - In a statement issued following official confirmation of the results of the April 15 municipal elections, Elaine Brown, former candidate for the City Council's 3rd District seat, said:

"The results of this Oakland municipal election show once again that reactionaries and racists in this city will not allow us to use the privileges of the Constitution freely to elect into city government candidates proven to be totally committed to the interests of the people in opposition to the power structure of this city, particularly if those candidates are Black.

"We were not fairly defeated in this election. Ballot boxes were tampered with; seals were broken or misapplied; ballots mysteriously were 'misplaced,' turning up hours later; tabulating systems were deliberately misleading and complicated and our opposition, in final desperation, had used a Nixon dirty trick in an attempt to discredit our campaign.

"With all this, the unity achieved in this campaign that brought together Black, White, worker, professional, young, elderly, men and women in equality, flatlands and the Oakland hills, is the real victory that cannot be stolen. Today we are more united in the city of Oakland than we have ever been. We are stronger. The day of complete victory is nearer at hand.

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